deputies and the procedures for their election are prescribed by law. Hence, their number varies from time to time; it is approximately 3,000. The NPC is elected for a term of 5 years. Its permanent organ is the Standing Committee consisting of approximately 200 members.

7. Communist Party Leadership The Chinese constitution recognizes a multi party system in the country. But, at the same time, it also clearly establishes the leadership role of the CPC. The Preamble says that the system of multi-party cooperation and political consultation under the leadership of the CPC will continue and develop long into the future. It also says that the Chinese people of all ethnic groups will continue, under the leadership of the CPC and the guidance of Marxism-Leninism, Mao Zedong. Thought, Deng Xiaoping Theory, the Theory of Three Represents, the Scientific Outlook on Development and Xi Jinping Thought on Socialism with Chinese Characteristics for a New Era, to uphold the people's democratic leadership, stay on the socialist road and develop the socialist market economy. Further, Article 1 declares that leadership by the CPC is the defining feature of socialism with Chinese characteristics.

8. Democratic Centralism The Chinese constitution declares that the state institutions shall practice the principle of democratic centralism. The NPC and the local people's congresses at all levels are created through democratic election and are responsible to the people and are also subject to their oversight. Also, all administrative, supervisory, adjudiciatory and procuratorial organs of the state are created by the people's congresses and are responsible to them and are also subject to their oversight. Further, the division of functions and powers between the central and local state institutions should honour the principle of giving full play to the initiative and motivation of local authorities under the unified leadership of the central authorities.

9. Fundamental Rights The constitution provides for a large number of rights to the citizens of China. They include civil, political, personal, economic, social and cultural rights. But, the enjoyment of these rights by the citizens should not undermine the interests of the state or society or collectives or the rights of other citizens. The list of rights is as follows:

(i) Right to equality before the law

(ii) Right to vote and stand for election

(iii) Freedom of speech, press, assembly, association, procession and demonstration

(iv) Freedom of religious belief

(v) Rights to inviolability of person and house

(vi) Right to personal dignity

(vii) Freedom and confidentiality of correspondence

(viii) Right to criticize

(ix) Right to file complaints

(x) Right to receive compensation

(xi) Right to work